

University Autonomy Framework Policy — Main Policy

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This main policy, prepared by University Administration, supports the implementation of University Autonomy Framework Policy. It sets out Policy outlining the framework for conferring academic and administrative autonomy on selected universities. and provides the operational direction needed for consistent, accountable practice.

Background and Scope

Stakeholders across University Administration have emphasised the importance of Autonomy as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present main policy responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, University Administration has prepared this main policy to give effect to Autonomy, Universities. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Object and Purpose

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Autonomy, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Universities across the system.

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Autonomy, Universities across University Administration-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

Policy Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Autonomy, Universities, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

The principal objectives are to strengthen Autonomy, harmonise institutional approaches to Universities, and establish measurable indicators through which progress can be tracked and reported.

Coverage

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Core Provisions

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Autonomy, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Universities.

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Autonomy, disclosure of material information to University Administration, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

Implementation Framework

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

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Accountability Framework

University Administration provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Autonomy, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Performance Monitoring

University Administration will review implementation against agreed indicators, publish consolidated outcomes, and engage institutions that require additional support or show exemplary practice.

Way Forward

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.